

Week 1 at a Glance

Wednesday–Saturday, September 2–5, 2026 · about two hours each morning

EVERY SCHOOL DAY

- Outdoor sit or walk, 20 min
- Bible, 10–15 min, then narrate
- Hymn or folk song, 5 min
- Ray’s Arithmetic, next lesson, 15–20 min
- Copywork, one line, 10 min
- Recitation, 5 min
- One main reading + narration
- One lighter reading or riches

HOLD ALL WEEK

Copywork: Slowly, silently, now the moon

Recitation: Genesis 1:1
In the beginning God created the heaven and the earth.

Hymn: first stanza of “I Bind Unto Myself Today”

Folk song: “The Bold Grenadier” — preview lyrics

Math: next Ray’s lesson. If opening fresh, start Ray’s Primary, oral work.

DAY	BIBLE	MAIN READING	RICHESS / EXTRA
Wed 2	Exodus 1	Island Story, “Harold”	Nature sit · “Silver” · hymn
Thu 3	Exodus 2	Little Duke, ch. 1 first half	Burgess Animal Book ch. 1 · folk song
Fri 4	Exodus 3	Two Gentlemen of Verona, start	Compass walk · Rockwell · hymn
Sat 5	Luke 19:1–9	Pilgrim’s Progress, gentle start	Bernstein excerpt · nature notebook · evening walk

Books to have open

- Bible
- Ray’s Arithmetic
- *Our Island Story* (Marshall), ch. “Harold”
- *The Little Duke* (Yonge), ch. 1
- *Burgess Animal Book for Children*, ch. 1
- Nesbit or Lamb, *Two Gentlemen of Verona*
- de la Mare, “Silver” in *Peacock Pie*
- Cheap compass · nature notebook · pencils

Skip *Tree in the Trail* and *Trial and Triumph* unless you already own them.

Two children

The 2nd grader does the whole morning. The preschooler joins Bible, songs, poems, animal stories, picture study, and outside. During math, copywork, and heavier history they play nearby with quiet work.

Heat

Bastrop in September. Outside at 8am or after 6pm. Not midday. Times on the day pages slide; keep the order.

Free sources

Island Story: [archive.org](#) · Little Duke: Gutenberg 3048 · Burgess: Gutenberg 2441 · Lamb 573 or Nesbit 1430 · “Silver” in *Peacock Pie*, 1913.

How to teach this week

Short lessons. Living books. One reading, then narration. You are not a textbook.

01 Narration is the lesson

Read once, close the book, let the child tell it back in their own words. You listen. Do not interrupt. Do not prompt with “and then what?” Wait. A few true sentences are enough. If they mix a name, let it stand unless the story broke. Thank them. Do not grade it.

02 Stop while they still want more

Fifteen to twenty minutes. A leftover page is better than a glazed child. If a chapter runs long, mark the spot and finish the next school day. Variety matters: Bible, then math, then a story, then a song. Do not stack two heavy readings.

03 Copywork, one line

Show the line. They copy it in their best handwriting, then stop. Not a paragraph. Not a worksheet. If the hand tires, fewer words tomorrow. This week’s line is from de la Mare: *Slowly, silently, now the moon.*

04 Recitation, a little every day

Say Genesis 1:1 together, then they try. No drill chart. When it sticks, add the first two lines of “Silver.” A poem learned by heart is a gift, not a test.

05 Ray’s Arithmetic

Oral work first when the book allows it. One lesson. Sit together. If they miss two in a row, stop and try those tomorrow. Do not add extra math from me.

06 Bible without a sermon

Read the passage. They narrate. You may add one true sentence. Do not turn Exodus into a lecture. Zacchaeus on Saturday is for both children.

07 Two children in one room

Preschooler sits for living stories, songs, poems, and nature. They are not expected to narrate Harold or Shakespeare. During math and copywork, give them quiet work in the same room: blocks, crayons, playdough, a basket of natural things. If they melt, send them outside and keep going with the 2nd grader.

08 Nature is looking, not naming

You are not a field guide. One thing: a pine, a web, a lizard, a cicada shell. Look. Draw. You may scribe one sentence they say. Names only if they ask. This week’s longer hunt is one invertebrate on Saturday evening.

09 Picture study

Look at Rockwell’s *Freedom of Speech* for four quiet minutes. Turn it over. They tell what was in the picture. Then look again. No art-history talk. Library book or a screen. Do not print a packet.

10 Music in the background

Play a short bit of Bernstein’s *Jeremiah* while they draw. Five to eight minutes. No quiz. If it is too heavy, still let it play once. Familiarity comes from hearing, not from explaining.

11 If it falls apart

Skip to outdoor time. Pick up tomorrow. These mornings are short so there is margin. A song and a walk still count as school.

12 Folk song caution

Preview “The Bold Grenadier” (also called “One Morning in May”). Some old verses are not for children. Sing a clean set. Hymn: only the first stanza of the Breastplate this month.

Wednesday

HAVE READY

Bible · hymn words · Ray's · copywork line · *Our Island Story* · "Silver" · nature notebook

8:00 **Nature sit** PRESCHOOLER JOINS

Backyard or porch. Twenty minutes. One thing only: a pine, a lizard, a web, or a cicada shell. Look. Do not name everything. Sketch if they want. This drawing comes back on Saturday.

8:25 **Bible · Exodus 1**

New king. Israelites as slaves. The midwives. Read once. Close the Bible. Narrate. One true sentence from you if needed, then stop.

8:40 **Hymn** PRESCHOOLER JOINS

First stanza of "I Bind Unto Myself Today" (St. Patrick's Breastplate). Long hymn. Learn only the opening this month. Sing. Do not explain it to death.

8:50 **Ray's Arithmetic**

Next lesson, 15–20 min. Oral first if the book allows. Stop while attention is still on. Preschooler: quiet work nearby.

9:10 **Copywork & recitation**

Copy: *Slowly, silently, now the moon*. Best handwriting, then stop. Recite Genesis 1:1 together, then they try.

9:25 **History · *Our Island Story*, "Harold"**

King Harold, 1066, the Norman landing. Stop at 20 minutes if the chapter runs long. Narrate: who Harold was, and what happened to him. Place "Harold, 1066" on a simple timeline if you keep one.

9:50 **Movement, then poem**

Run around the house or stretch. Then read de la Mare's "Silver" once. No talk after unless they start it. Books done about 10:10. Free play.

If the morning slips, keep Bible, Ray's, Harold, and the nature sit. Drop the hymn and poem to tomorrow.

Thursday

HAVE READY

Bible · folk song (previewed) · Ray's · *The Little Duke* · *Burgess Animal Book* ch. 1

8:00 **Short yard time** OPTIONAL

Ten minutes if Wednesday's sit went well. Or skip and save the long walk for Saturday evening.

8:20 **Bible · Exodus 2** PRESCHOOLER JOINS

Baby Moses, the basket, the Egyptian, flight to Midian. Read once. Narrate. The preschooler will hold the basket; the 2nd grader should hold the whole thread.

8:35 **Folk song**

"The Bold Grenadier," also sung as "One Morning in May." Preview the lyrics first. Some old verses are not for children. Sing a clean set. Both children.

8:45 **Ray's, copywork, recitation**

Next Ray's lesson. Copywork: *Slowly, silently, now the moon*. Recitation: Genesis 1:1. If the verse is sticking, add the first two lines of "Silver" at the end of the morning.

9:20 **Tales · *The Little Duke*, ch. 1 first half**

A boy named Richard in Normandy. Read the first half only. Stop even if they beg. Narrate who Richard is and where he lives. Gutenberg 3048 if you need the text.

9:50 **Natural history · Burgess ch. 1** PRESCHOOLER JOINS

"Jenny Wren Gives Peter Rabbit an Idea." Both children. This is the easy living-science of the week. Narrate. Peter is about to go to school under Old Mother Nature; that is enough for today.

10:10 **Done**

Books finished. If anyone is still bright, reread "Silver." Do not add another chapter.

If you must cut: keep Bible, Ray's, Little Duke, and Burgess. Folk song can wait for Saturday.

Friday

HAVE READY

Bible · hymn · Ray's · Shakespeare tale (Nesbit or Lamb) · cheap compass · Rockwell, *Freedom of Speech*

8:20

Bible · Exodus 3

The burning bush. Read once. Narrate. Let the strange fire sit. You do not need to unpack every name of God today.

8:35

Hymn, Ray's, copywork, recitation

Same stanza as Wednesday. Next Ray's lesson. Copywork: the moon line. Recitation: Genesis 1:1. Preschooler: quiet work through math and copywork, then they may come for Shakespeare and picture study if they will sit.

9:20

Shakespeare · start *The Two Gentlemen of Verona*

Nesbit's *Beautiful Stories* or Lamb's *Tales*. One sitting. Do not finish the play. The next AO play is not for weeks. Narrate whatever you actually read: who the gentlemen are, and what the first tangle is. If it is too talky, stop after a few pages. That still counts.

9:50

Geography · compass PRESCHOOLER JOINS

Go outside. Cheap compass. North, south, east, west. Hide the compass. Let the 2nd grader point. Preschooler plays "find north." If the sun is up, notice which wall it hits in the morning. No worksheet.

10:10

Picture study · Rockwell, *Freedom of Speech*

Look four minutes in silence. Turn it over. Child tells what was there (the standing man, the town meeting, the faces). Look once more. Library book or a museum image on a screen. Do not print a homemade packet. Copyright still holds; looking is the lesson.

If you must cut: keep Bible, Ray's, compass, and picture study. Shakespeare can split into next week.

Saturday

HAVE READY

Bible · folk song · Ray's · a simple way to tell Pilgrim's Progress · Bernstein excerpt · nature notebook · evening walk plan

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- 8:20** **Bible · Luke 19:1–9** **PRESCHOOLER JOINS**
 Zacchaeus. Both children. Read once. Narrate. This is the joyful reading of the week. Let them climb the tree in the telling.
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- 8:35** **Folk song, Ray's, copywork, recitation**
 Clean verses of "The Bold Grenadier." Next Ray's lesson. Copywork: the moon line. Recitation: Genesis 1:1, and "Silver" if it has begun to stick.
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- 9:20** **Literature · *Pilgrim's Progress*, a gentle start**
 Do not start with the verse preface. In five minutes, tell that this is a story of a man named Christian who leaves home and travels to the Celestial City. If they want more, read the opening of the dream ("As I walked through the wilderness of this world...") and stop. Narrate. The City of Destruction waiting can wait until a later week.
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- 9:45** **Composer · Bernstein, *Jeremiah***
 Five to eight minutes of Symphony No. 1 while they draw. Legal stream or library recording. No quiz. If it feels heavy, that is all right. Hearing it once is the whole lesson.
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- 10:00** **Handicraft · nature notebook** **PRESCHOOLER JOINS**
 Draw Wednesday's pine, web, or bug. You may scribe one sentence they say, dated. This is the handicraft. Keep it twenty minutes. Stop while the drawing still pleases them.
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- After 6** **Evening walk · Lost Pines or a creek**
 Bastrop heat. Not midday. Prompt: find one invertebrate (spider, cricket, ant, caterpillar). Look. Not a field-guide test. Draw later only if they ask. A song on the way home still counts.
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Week 1 is done when Saturday's walk is done. Next week's plan lands Tuesday morning.